Boston Sunday Globe

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FEBRUARY 23, 2025

A bold call on housing to end the single-family

Panel suggests state allow multifamilies on most home lots

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

Single-family neighborhoods are synonymous with the American Dream. Their driveways and grassy yards define the communities of suburban America, including Greater Boston.

But are they also compounding Massachusetts' deep housing crisis?

A state-appointed commission focused on the state's worsening housing shortage in fact identified single-family-only zoning — the land-use rules that created suburban single-family neighborhoods — as a primary obstacle blocking the surge of construction Massachusetts desperately needs to address its housing problem.

And so the commission proposes a seemingly profound idea: Get rid of single-family zoning — everywhere in Massachusetts.

Instead, state leaders should adopt a new zoning regime that would allow property owners to build small, multifamily homes on virtually any residential lot.

HOUSING, Page A15

Post game time with Jack Edwards

Former voice of Bruins still cheering on

By Mark Shanahan
GLOBE STAFF

RUTLAND COUNTY, Vt. — Jack Edwards is smiling when he opens the door.

"Dr. Livingstone, I presume," he says, greeting a visitor who has arrived after dark at the wintry getaway where the former Bruins play-by-play announcer spends much of his time these days.

The out-of-towner is an emissary of sorts, here on behalf of hockey diehards who wonder — and worry — about Edwards since a medical condition affecting his speech forced him to abruptly retire after last season.

Edwards, 67, called Bruins games on NESN for two decades, during which the team notched more wins than any other NHL franchise, and he was beloved for his unabashed homerism, an over-the-top exuberance — "on Donder, on Blitzen, on Seidenberg!" — that fans came to appreciate as much as a sprawling glove save or sizzling one-timer.

"I love Jack. His call was impeccable," says Mike Curtis, a longtime Bruins fan from Woburn who delighted in the announcer's catchphrases, including "tumbling muf-

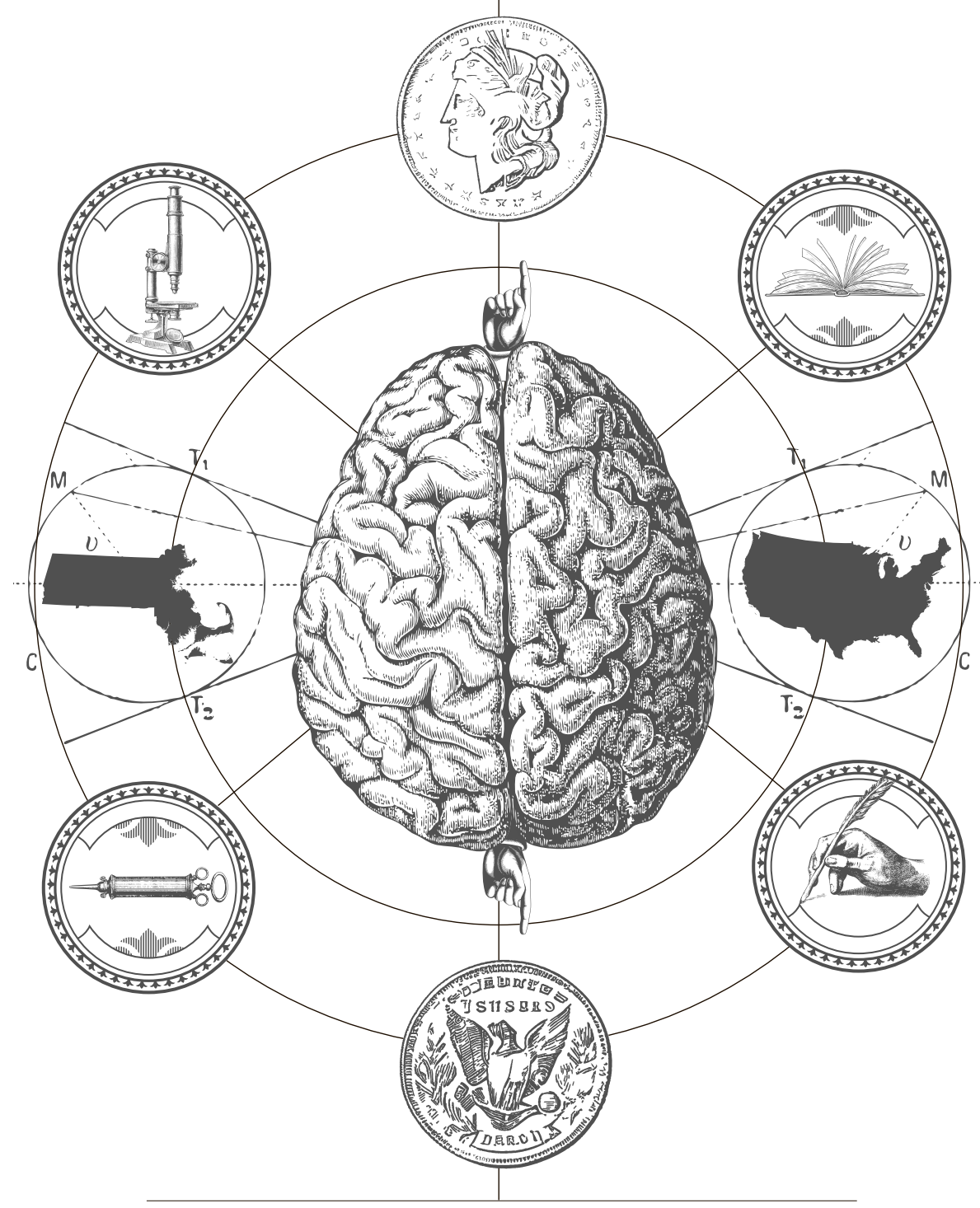
EDWARDS, Page A14



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Because of his condition, Jack Edwards is no longer part of the Bruins action, but he continues to tune in to every game.

Brain freeze?



The core of the Mass. economy, eds and meds, under fire from D.C.

SHIRLEY LEUNG
COMMENTARY

The strength of the Massachusetts economy comes down to one thing: brain power.

It has become our brand and identity — powered by the scientific and medical advances from Nobel Prize-winning scientists and professors at world-renowned universities and hospitals, and the life-changing innovations emerging out of corporate labs from Kendall Square to the Seaport.

Now it all feels vulnerable. Really vulnerable.

Together, the education and health care industries employ roughly a million people in Massachusetts — nearly a quarter of all wages. This so-called eds and meds sector — which has become the state's economic superpower in creating jobs, launching companies, and providing stability through recessions — is being rocked to its core as the Trump administration attempts to slash NIH funding and dismantle the Department of Education, which could throw billions of dollars in student loans and grants into flux, while the Republican-controlled Congress aims to rein in Medicaid spending.

The potential fallout will be felt far beyond universities and hospitals, economists and business leaders say, because the sector is so integral to the state's econ-

MASSACHUSETTS, Page A12

Truck stop: Sales stalled over EV rules

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

A showdown between state regulators and truck manufacturers has brought the market for new heavy vehicles in Massachusetts to a virtual standstill, challenging businesses from landscapers and long-haulers to the dealers who supply them.

The Healey administration on Jan. 1 instituted a requirement that electric vehicles make up at least 7 percent of new medium and heavy duty trucks sold in Massachusetts. But dealers say the industry isn't ready. And buyers, worried about costs and the logistics of charging, remain wary of electric vehicles for many applications.

Prices for electric versions are double or more than diesel trucks and there are almost no charging stations on highways for big rigs. Faced with possible fines for missing the targets, manufacturers have in turn passed the burden onto truck dealers, requiring them to sell one electric model before they can sell 10 or more diesel models.

The so-called ratio requirement has left local dealers turning away hundreds of customers for diesel trucks, according to Kevin Weeks, executive director of the dealer industry group Trucking Association of Massa-

TRUCKS, Page A15

Pope Francis was in critical condition after he suffered a prolonged asthmatic respiratory crisis while being treated for pneumonia and a complex lung infection, the Vatican said. **World, A2.**

Fighting rare diseases and more in the health edition of the **Globe Magazine.**

A journey through Krakow offers mysteries wrapped in legend and wondrous tales. **Travel, N13.**

Drop the gloves

Sunday: Partly sunny. High: 39-44. Low: 23-28.
Monday: Clouds, sun. High: 41-46. Low: 31-36.
Sunrise: 6:29 Sunset: 5:27
Complete report, **A22.**
Deaths, **A16-21.**

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